

Education

University of Toronto, 2022-

PhD in Ecology & Evolutionary Biology, University of Toronto
Supervisors: Drs. Matthew Osmond, Nicole Mideo

- **Research interests:** recombination & mutation; function-valued traits; viral evolution & emergence; modifier theory; coalescent theory; ancestral recombination graphs; phylogenetic comparative methods
- **Teaching:** [EEB313: Quantitative Methods in R for Biologists](#) (co-instructor in F23 and F24)
- **TAing:** EEB319: Population Ecology (F23 and F25), EEB325: Evolutionary Medicine (W25), EEB362: Macroevolution (F22), EEB462: Quantitative Genetics (F22), BIO120: Adaptation and Biodiversity (F22), EEB313: Quantitative Methods in R for Biologists (course development, W23)

University of Idaho, 2018-2022

BSc in Mathematics *General & Applied Quant. Modeling Options*
BSc in Statistical Science *General Option*

Publications

- **Yuksel, M.**, Yang, Q., Osmond, M.*, Mideo, N.* [Elevated viral recombination in short-lived hosts](#). In revision at *Proceedings of the Royal Society B*.
- **Yuksel, M.** & Mideo, N. (2026). [Host jumps need not be common just because spillover is](#). *PLoS Biology*.
- Keefer, M., **Yuksel, M. K.**, & Caudill, C. (2025). [Assessing the role of juvenile life history diversity and adult translocation on cohort productivity in a Chinook Salmon population](#). *Fisheries*.
- **Yuksel, M.**, Remien, C., Karki, B., Bull, J., & Krone, S. (2021). [Vector dynamics influence spatially imperfect genetic interventions against disease](#). *Evolution, Medicine, & Public Health*.

Non-peer reviewed:

- Keefer, M., **Yuksel, M.**, & Caudill, C. (2022). Decision Support Modeling for Outplanting Adult Chinook Salmon in the Santiam River Basin (Technical Report 2022-1 for US Army Corps of Engineers).

Selected grants & awards

2025	NSF APPEX (Analysis and Prediction of Pandemic Expansion) Seed Grant (\$10,000 USD)
2024-27	University of Toronto Data Sciences Institute Doctoral Fellowship (\$79,500 CAD)
2023-24	University of Toronto Institute for Pandemics Graduate Studentship (\$10,000 CAD)
2022-27	Connaught International Doctoral Scholarship (\$50,000 CAD)
2022-24	Faculty of Arts & Science Doctoral Recruitment Award (\$10,000 CAD)
2022	John B. George Award, awarded to the top graduating senior in the College of Science

Selected presentations

2026	Atwood Colloquium in EEB; SMBE; Evolution; Social Lives of Viruses
2025	Evolution; Theory and Modeling in Population Biology
2024	Evolution; Mathematical Models in Ecology & Evolution
2023	Ecology & Evolution of Infectious Diseases; Atwood Colloquium in EEB

Selected service

Ongoing	Ad hoc reviewer for <i>Genetics</i> (x13), <i>G3</i> (x6), <i>eLife</i> (x1), <i>Proc B</i> (x2), <i>Evolution</i> (x1), <i>JEB</i> (x1)
2024-25	University of Toronto Atwood Colloquium in Ecology & Evolution Organizing Co-Chair
2024-27	Member of Society for the Study of Evolution (SSE) Graduate Council
2022-23	CUPE 3902 Steward for Dept. Ecology & Evolutionary Biology